

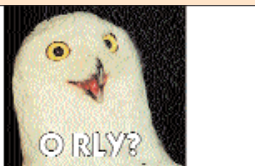


whatweretheythinking.com

www.oryowl.com

It's getting to be a sort of record here. Every time we pick a site for this space, we feel there can't be another more tear-provoking. Orlyowl.com had us whipping out our handkerchiefs.

An Internet meme that became popular mid-2003, O-RLY is a well-known-on-the-Web term for "Oh Really." Used to convey sarcasm on Net forums, it appeared along with the image of a snowy owl, thus bestowing cult status upon the bird.



Two hoots for the O-RLY owl site

The site, clearly designed to be a spoof of the original owl, claims it is "The home of the infamous O RLY! owl. This site hopes to catalogue all of the spin-offs from the original." A set of links on the left largely contain only two sets of

images—pictures of real owls and pictures of the original Snowy owl, coupled with images of popular American icons—actors and shows included.

If you do spend a few minutes at the site, the image of the snowy owl will have been imprinted upon your optical cortex. Owl, owl, OWL! The aim of the site seems to be to get you to upload your own version of owl—there's a helpful "blank owl template." What actually made us gasp is the number of images that have actually been uploaded by visitors—no less than four thousand!

A spoof's a fine idea if it can actually make you laugh, but clicking on a couple of images (of owls, of course!) is all it takes to end your curiosity. Yawns guaranteed!

Even if you absolutely love Owls, would we recommend that you take a look at the site? NT-RLY...

than women to visit blogs! Why? A possible explanation is the following: women are slow to catch on. (Please direct all hate mail to readersletters@thinkdigit.com with the subject line "ALL MEN ARE MCPs" in caps.) In the early days of the Net, Web surfers were all men—well, more than 90 per cent, as we remember it. When there was talk about Web sites, women would go, "Oh, you're talking about the Internets! Yes, I've heard of those! They're special computers!" (Hate mail to the address above, please) And now, in the relatively early days of blogs, women are catching on more slowly.

Back to the survey: it found that 16 per cent of men had visited a porn site while at work; 8 per cent of women had done so. Now on the one hand, it's a no-brainer—porn is primarily targeted at men anyway. But *eight per cent* of women view porn while at work? What is the world coming to? Where have values gone?

More fun findings: women tend to visit travel-related sites more than men do. Of course—isn't your wife always clamouring for that next vacation? Then, women who encounter spyware are more likely than men to complain—they are *more than twice as likely* as men to call their help desk or IT department if their computer got infected with spyware! Talk about damsels in distress!

Then, men use IMs at work more than women do, which comes as a surprise. (Women are more chatty.) Men are also more likely to listen to MP3s on their work PCs. (This is something we've seen first-hand right here at Digit, and we just don't know why!)

Finally, men are also more likely than women to have heard of the term "phishing." Ostensibly, therefore, women get phished on a more regular basis, but that's just a wild guess. Still, just to be on the safe side, don't give out your bank details to your wife!

Blog WATCH

Does blogging provide an advantage over traditional media? What makes a blog stand apart? With our hard disks and what not, what's the best way to prevent data from vanishing into the void in the case of an apocalypse? Some serious musings.

Lorelle

<http://snipurl.com/blogjun1>
(<http://lorelle.wordpress.com/2006/05/02/blogs-that-stand-out/>)

Blogs That Stand Out

What is it about a blog that makes it stand out from the blogging crowd for you? Is it the pretty? The interesting web page design that makes it enjoyable to look at as well as read?

Is it the content, the words, the ideas, the point of view that captures your attention and keeps you returning for more? Do you have to agree with their opinion or perspective or do you make return visits because they are the opposite of your point of view? Or because you find it entertaining? ...

Mark Cuban

<http://snipurl.com/blogjun2>
(www.blogmaverick.com/entry/1234000500073690/)

Blog Vs Traditional media

A blog is media. It's a platform to communicate that can reach anyone within reach of an Internet connection. I've been writing this blog for more than 2 years and that time has allowed me to recognize the difference between a blog and traditional media and why the two will never successfully meet.

In traditional media, you are first defined by your medium. There is some constraint to the physical or digital definition of the medium the content is delivered on or by, that for the most part determines how you are perceived.

Seth Godin

<http://snipurl.com/blogjun3>
(http://sethgodin.typepad.com/seths_blog/2006/05/the_problem_wit.html)

The problem with mobile

Why hasn't the whole cell phone industry exploded?

I don't mean the "use a portable phone to call people" market. That market is doing great, because everyone knows how to use a phone and a cell phone is just a better solution to that problem for a lot of uses.

I mean the entire "data in my pocket" or "fundamentally different kind of interaction" business. For years, everyone has been talking about the coming goldmine in mobile.

ClickRich

<http://snipurl.com/blogjun4>
(<http://clickrich.blogspot.com/2006/05/best-long-term-storage-format.html>)

Best long-term storage format?

Ok, so let's take everything we read in the papers at face value and, between the celeb worshipping and reality TV, assume we take some time out to plan for the demise of humanity. Think of a disastrous event which wipes out, say, 99% of the human population on earth. Now think about you being one of those 'lucky' enough to come out blinking into the light. Let's say you reinstate the basic needs of warmth, food, shelter etc. Now, what would be the best way to access the thousands of years of civilisation's knowledge to start to develop society and technology as fast as possible?